Week 8 | Teaching map

December 7 to 11 | A family prepares for winter, and each penguin responds in a different way.

Book-centered week

Little Penguins | A family prepares for winter, and each penguin responds in a different way. Story focus: Notice the signs of winter, the family's preparations and the penguin who chooses to stay home.

Reading and writing

Grade 3

TEKS 3.8C

Analyze plot elements, including the sequence of events, the conflict, and the resolution.

In plain English: Explain the order of story events, the problem and how it is solved.

TEKS 3.7D

Retell and paraphrase texts in ways that maintain meaning and logical order.

In plain English: Retell or put a text into your own words while keeping its meaning and order.

2026-12-07

Answer who and where questions; identify the first event with a picture or page clue.

2026-12-08

Answer what happened next and place that event in the sequence.

2026-12-09

Retell the beginning, middle and end with three visual event cards.

2026-12-10

Answer a why or how question with a picture, AAC response or page detail.

2026-12-11

Retell the event sequence and answer three new story WH questions.

Grade 4

TEKS 4.8C

Analyze plot elements, including the rising action, climax, falling action, and resolution.

In plain English: Explain how a story builds to its turning point and moves toward a solution.

TEKS 4.7C

Use text evidence to support an appropriate response.

In plain English: Support an answer with something the text actually says or shows.

2026-12-07

Find the story problem and explain a character's first action with an illustration.

2026-12-08

Sequence a character's action and explain what changes next.

2026-12-09

Explain the beginning, middle and end, including how a character responds.

2026-12-10

Explain why a character acts and show a page clue for the result.

2026-12-11

Explain the problem and solution; support one answer with page evidence.

Teach and collect evidence

Use the dated lesson sheet for I Do, We Do, You Do and the independent rotation. Record the exact response, correct/total and support separately. Friday checks use the same targets.

Math

Grade 3

TEKS 3.3F

Represent equivalent fractions with denominators of 2, 3, 4, 6, and 8 using a variety of objects and pictorial models, including number lines.

In plain English: Use models or number lines to show equivalent fractions.

TEKS 3.3G

Explain that two fractions are equivalent if and only if they are both represented by the same point on the number line or represent the same portion of a same size whole for an area model.

In plain English: Explain why equivalent fractions mark the same point or cover the same amount of an equal-size whole.

TEKS 3.3H

Compare two fractions having the same numerator or denominator in problems by reasoning about their sizes and justifying the conclusion using symbols, words, objects, and pictorial models.

In plain English: Compare fractions with the same numerator or denominator and justify which is greater.

2026-12-07

Match one third with two sixths and show that the amounts are equal.

2026-12-08

Compare three fourths and one fourth; show which is larger and why.

2026-12-09

Compare three fourths and one fourth; show which is larger and why.

2026-12-10

Compare three fourths and one fourth; show which is larger and why.

2026-12-11

Compare three fourths and one fourth; show which is larger and why.

Grade 4

TEKS 4.3A

Represent a fraction a/b as a sum of fractions 1/b, where a and b are whole numbers and b > 0, including when a > b.

In plain English: Build fractions, including amounts greater than one, by adding unit fractions.

TEKS 4.3B

Decompose a fraction in more than one way into a sum of fractions with the same denominator using concrete and pictorial models and recording results with symbolic representations.

In plain English: Break a fraction into same-denominator sums in more than one way; show models and equations.

TEKS 4.3E

Represent and solve addition and subtraction of fractions with equal denominators using objects and pictorial models that build to the number line and properties of operations.

In plain English: Model and solve fraction addition and subtraction with equal denominators.

2026-12-07

Build a fresh like-denominator sum or difference; name one and one half from the model.

2026-12-08

Build a fresh like-denominator sum or difference; name one and one half from the model.

2026-12-09

Build a fresh like-denominator sum or difference; name one and one half from the model.

2026-12-10

Build a fresh like-denominator sum or difference; name one and one half from the model.

2026-12-11

Build a fresh like-denominator sum or difference; name one and one half from the model.

Teach and collect evidence

Use the dated lesson sheet for I Do, We Do, You Do and the independent rotation. Record the exact response, correct/total and support separately. Friday checks use the same targets.

Science

Grade 3

TEKS 3.8B

Plan and conduct investigations that demonstrate how the speed of an object is related to its mechanical energy.

In plain English: Plan and carry out a test connecting an object's speed to its mechanical energy.

TEKS 3.8A

Identify everyday examples of energy, including light, sound, thermal, and mechanical.

In plain English: Recognize everyday examples of light, sound, thermal and mechanical energy.

2026-12-07

Compare slow and faster runs of the same car; use the effect on a foam block to explain the relationship between speed and mechanical energy.

2026-12-08

Compare slow and faster runs of the same car; use the effect on a foam block to explain the relationship between speed and mechanical energy.

2026-12-09

Compare slow and faster runs of the same car; use the effect on a foam block to explain the relationship between speed and mechanical energy.

2026-12-10

Compare slow and faster runs of the same car; use the effect on a foam block to explain the relationship between speed and mechanical energy.

2026-12-11

Compare slow and faster runs of the same car; use the effect on a foam block to explain the relationship between speed and mechanical energy.

Grade 4

TEKS 4.7

Plan and conduct descriptive investigations to explore the patterns of forces such as gravity, friction, or magnetism in contact or at a distance on an object.

In plain English: Plan and conduct investigations to find patterns in gravity, friction or magnetism.

2026-12-07

Test a pattern in gravity, friction or magnetism.

2026-12-08

Test a pattern in gravity, friction or magnetism.

2026-12-09

Test a pattern in gravity, friction or magnetism.

2026-12-10

Test a pattern in gravity, friction or magnetism.

2026-12-11

Test a pattern in gravity, friction or magnetism.

Teach and collect evidence

Use the dated lesson sheet for I Do, We Do, You Do and the independent rotation. Record the exact response, correct/total and support separately. Friday checks use the same targets.

Social studies

Grade 3

TEKS 3.1A

Describe how individuals, events, and ideas have changed communities, past and present.

In plain English: Explain how people, events and ideas have changed communities.

TEKS 3.9C

Identify and describe individual acts of civic responsibility, including obeying laws, serving and improving the community, serving on a jury, and voting.

In plain English: Describe civic responsibilities such as following laws, helping the community, jury service and voting.

TEKS 3.2B

Compare ways in which people in the local community and other communities meet their needs for government, education, communication, transportation, and recreation.

In plain English: Compare how communities meet needs such as government, education, transportation and recreation.

2026-12-07

Identify a community change caused by people.

2026-12-08

Explain an action that improves a community.

2026-12-09

Compare how two communities meet the same need.

2026-12-10

Plan a helpful action and explain the expected result.

2026-12-11

Show a community problem, action and result.

Grade 4

TEKS 4.3C

Identify leaders important to the founding of Texas as a republic and state, including José Antonio Navarro, Sam Houston, Mirabeau Lamar, and Anson Jones.

In plain English: Identify leaders who helped establish Texas as a republic and a state.

TEKS 4.3D

Describe the successes, problems, and organizations of the Republic of Texas such as the establishment of a constitution, economic struggles, relations with American Indians, and the Texas Rangers.

In plain English: Describe the Republic of Texas's successes, problems and organizations.

TEKS 4.3E

Explain the events that led to the annexation of Texas to the United States and the impact of the U.S.-Mexican War.

In plain English: Explain how Texas became part of the United States and the effects of the U.S.-Mexican War.

2026-12-07

Identify a leader of the Republic of Texas.

2026-12-08

Explain a challenge faced by the Republic.

2026-12-09

Describe one success of the Republic.

2026-12-10

Place annexation in the Texas timeline.

2026-12-11

Explain how a Republic event connects to statehood.

Teach and collect evidence

Use the dated lesson sheet for I Do, We Do, You Do and the independent rotation. Record the exact response, correct/total and support separately. Friday checks use the same targets.